Responsible Administrator: CIO
Responsible Office: Office of Technology
Effective Date: 04/01/2025
Approved by: President
Date of Revision: 11/07/2025

Artificial Intelligence Policy

Policy Statement

While artificial intelligence (AI) tools offer opportunities to streamline work functions and increase our productivity, they come with serious security, accuracy, and intellectual property risks. Publicly available applications driven by AI, including generative AI that includes large language models (LLMs), chatbots, or image generators, are widely popular. This policy highlights the unique issues raised by AI, helps employees understand the guidelines for its acceptable use, and protects the university's confidential information, intellectual property, culture, commitment to diversity, and brand.

Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to the use of any third-party or publicly available AI tools that mimic human intelligence to generate or analyze answers, create content, or perform certain tasks by faculty, staff, students, contractors and volunteers of Southeastern Louisiana University. For all research projects involving human participants, the project must still be reviewed according to Institutional Review Board policies and procedures.

This policy is effective as of April 1, 2025. While previous AI usage is not subject to the specific requirements herein, users are encouraged to review the policy, align their practices accordingly, and notify supervisors of previous AI usage.

Definitions

Artificial Intelligence (AI): A broad term encompassing any technique that enables computers to mimic human intelligence, such as problem-solving, learning, and decision-making. This includes, but is not limited to, machine learning, natural language processing, and computer vision.

Generative AI: A type of AI that can create new content, including text, images, audio, and code. This includes Large Language Models (LLMs), chatbots, and image generators.

Confidential Information: Information that is protected by law, regulation, university policy, or contractual obligation. This includes, but is not limited to, student records subject to FERPA, health information subject to HIPAA, financial information subject to GLBA, proprietary information (such as intellectual property and system credentials), and any other information that could be considered protected university data.

ERP Committee: The ERP committee is appointed by the President to lead in Enterprise Resource Planning for the university. This committee provides high-level, strategic oversight and decision-making for IT projects. It ensures that projects align with business objectives, stays on budget, manages risks, facilitates cross-functional alignment, and is properly communicated to the campus community where appropriate.

Intellectual Property: Creations of the mind, such as inventions, literary and artistic works, designs, and symbols, used in commerce. This includes, but is not limited to, patents, copyrights, trademarks, and trade secrets.

FERPA: The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, a federal law that protects the privacy of student education records.

Proprietary Information: Any data that the university develops or owns that should remain secret and should have restricted access.

Restricted Data: Information that requires security and authorization for access, as its disclosure could lead to legal, ethical, or financial consequences for the university.

HIPAA: The Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act, a federal law that protects the privacy and security of health information.

GLBA: The Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act, a federal law that protects the security and confidentiality of personal financial information.

PII: Personal Identifying Information, any information that can be used to distinguish or trace an individual's identity, either on its own or when combined with other information.

Click-Through Agreement: A type of contract formed by clicking a button or checking a box indicating acceptance of terms and conditions, often associated with software and online services.

Policy Procedure

Requirements for Allowable Use of AI

- For faculty, staff, student workers, graduate assistants, research assistants, contractors and volunteers, supervisors must be aware of any AI usage.
- For students, AI usage must be consistent with course AI usage guidelines that are found in each course syllabus.
- For faculty, the use of AI should follow all guidelines provided in the Semester Informational Memo provided by the Provost and Vice President for Academic Affairs.
- Any use of AI should be disclosed in the work product whenever possible and appropriate.
- Any use of AI where the AI is given access to data that could be considered PII, specific information about tangible or real property, proprietary information, confidential data, restricted data, or any information that would otherwise undermine the cybersecurity or physical security of the university *will require review by the university ERP committee*.
- Any use of AI where data that is publicly available or published university information is allowed without ERP committee approval.
- Any use of AI should be consistent with the Responsible Computing Policy, Intellectual Property Policy, and Academic Integrity Policy.

Prohibited Use of AI

- AI cannot be given access to PII, specific information about tangible or real property, proprietary information, confidential data, restricted data, or any information that would otherwise undermine the cybersecurity or physical security of the university *unless it is reviewed by the university ERP committee*. In general, student records subject to FERPA, health information subject to HIPAA, financial information subject to GLBA, proprietary information (such as intellectual property and system credentials), and any other information that could be considered protected university data must not be used with any AI without ERP review.
- AI may not be used for any activity that would be illegal, fraudulent or a violation of any state or federal law, or Southeastern policies.

- While AI may be used to generate useful output, it lacks the context, ethical considerations, and human judgment and may introduce bias. Examples of tasks that AI should never be used for include, but are not limited to recruitment decisions, personnel decision making, disciplinary decision making, and grading decisions.
- AI generated content may be misleading, inaccurate, or without proper attribution or permission. It is the responsibility of the user to review the accuracy and ownership of any AI generated content.

Academic Integrity
For guidance on how AI intersects with academic honesty, it is recommended that instructors contact the Center for Faculty Excellence and review the Academic Integrity Policy. Be aware that AI detection tools are not always accurate and may produce false positives or miss certain cases. It is important to use these tools as part of a broader evaluation process rather than relying solely on their results.

Purchase Review Process
For all software purchases that include AI components and renewals/updates that introduce AI into existing software, there will be a mandatory review by the ERP committee. This review process will ensure that all new software aligns with the organization's strategic objectives, ethical guidelines, and security protocols. The committee will thoroughly screen the software for potential risks, including issues related to data privacy, bias, ownership, and compliance with regulatory frameworks. Furthermore, they will assess its compatibility with existing IT infrastructure to prevent system fragmentation and ensure a seamless integration. This scrutiny allows the organization to mitigate legal and reputational risks while fostering a responsible and secure approach to AI.

AI Inventory and Tracking
An inventory of AI usage shall be maintained by the Office of Technology. Supervisors should notify the Chief Information Officer (CIO) at technology@southeastern.edu regarding any AI usage. The CIO will consult the ERP committee if review is necessary. While there exist current mechanisms for tracking unauthorized usage, the responsibility for the disclosure and approval remains with the individual.

Personal Liability
Faculty, staff, and students must oversee every decision or recommendation generated by AI to ensure its appropriateness, accuracy, and fairness. AI tools can assist with decision-making, but they lack the context, ethical considerations, and human judgments bring to complex scenarios. Faculty, staff, and students are accountable for all content created using AI. Users are responsible for the decisions that are based on that output. Users of AI must ensure that there are no instances of improper attribution, false information, violations of intellectual property protections, violations of data privacy, or any other related concerns.

AI models often include biases due to the data they are trained on and the design. These biases may reflect historical inequities, societal prejudices, or other imbalances present in the training data, potentially leading to unfair or unintended outcomes. It's important to critically evaluate AI outputs and recognize that these systems are not infallible. Many AI tools use click-through (end user) agreements. Click-through agreements are contracts. Individuals who accept click-through agreements without delegated signature authority may face personal consequences, including responsibility for compliance with terms and conditions.

Additional Guidance
For questions regarding the appropriate use of AI, please contact the Chief Information Officer at technology@southeastern.edu.

Southeastern recognizes that AI technology is evolving rapidly. Therefore, this policy will be updated as needed.

[End of Policy]